

Phoenix Astronomical Society, Inc.

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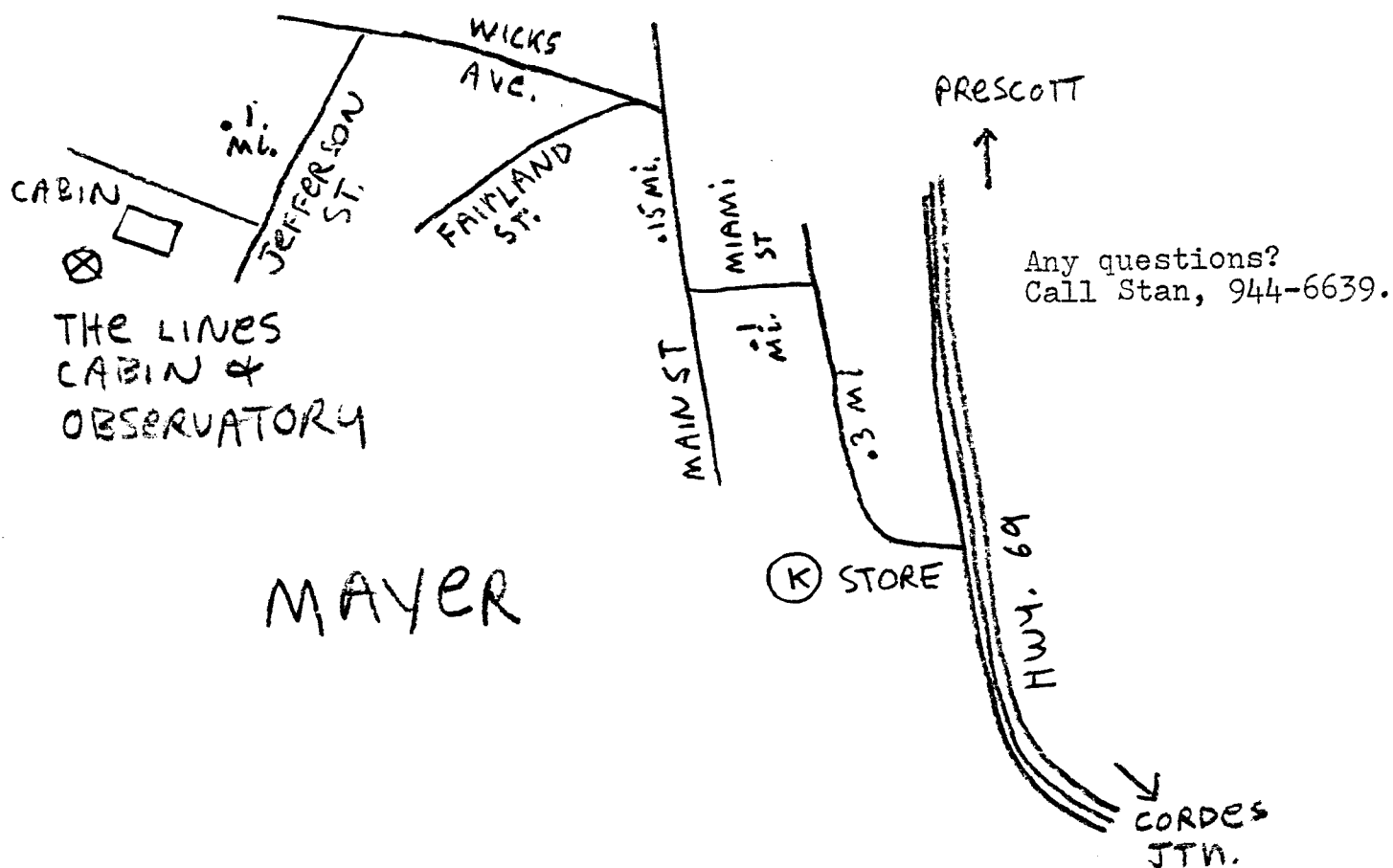
STAR PARTY AUGUST 6

The August Star Party will be at Helen and Richard Lines' home and observatory in Mayer on August 6th. Do not plan on the Lines' 20 inch being available for observing so bring your own telescope. Coffee and cookies will be furnished. Please do not arrive before 6 pm.

We must request for this Star Party that there be

ABSOLUTLY NO CHILDREN UNDER 15.

Heres a map:



There will be much of astronomical intrest during the Star Party;

1. A minor meteor shower, the δ Aquarids. Maximum should be Aug. 5th., but the shower extends from July 15 to Aug. 25.

2. Jupiter's moon Ganymede will enter Jupiter's shadow at 9:13 and reappear at 11:37, M.S.T.

3. Uranus and Neptune are very well placed for easy finding:

Uranus about $1\frac{1}{2}$ degree east of the star ω in Scorpius. and
Neptune about $1\frac{1}{2}$ degree west of the star μ in Sagittarius

CORRECTION

In July's newsletter it was printed that Rick Hill "of the Lunar and Planetary Lab" is going to speak to our Society on September 23 in room C-102 of the Science Building at Phoenix College. Well, he's still Rick Hill; the talk is still September 23 in room C-102 of the Science Building at Phoenix College; but... Rick is of the Warner and Swasey Station at Kitt Peak. Sorry.

CHANGES

As you may have noticed, Raul Espinoza has a new phone number: 948-3617. It's on the letter-head, please use it.

John DeVries has a new address: c/o Gould S.E.L.
1226 N. University Dr.
Plantation, Florida
33322

A NEW BOARD MEMBER

At the last meeting of the officers and board members it was decided to appoint Trevor Tuffin to the vacant position on the board of directors. Trevor has graciously accepted.

FOR SALE

A 16 inch unfinished mirror, 3 inches thick, Pyrex.....	\$600.00
A 16 inch unfinished mirror, 1.61 inches thick, Pyrex.....	\$300.00
A 16 inch f/5, aluminized mirror, 1.61 inches thick, Pyrex..	\$500.00
A 16 inch mirror cell for the above finished mirror.....	\$ 50.00

Call Stan if interested, 944-6639.

Stan gave me this, he found it in the National Newsletter of The Royal Astronomical Society of Canada.

Ten Laws of Astrophotography

by Clive Gibbons
Hamilton Centre

When one has been engaged in the pursuit of astrophotography for a number of years, one realizes the existence of several Great Truths which rule the discipline. These revelations usually present themselves towards the end of a particularly fruitless observing session. The veteran astrophotographer has no doubt experienced some or all of the following. To the novice let them be a warning ...

- 1 *Fosdick's Law of Field Rotation*
The probability of finding a bright guidestar close to the object you wish to photograph is inversely proportional to the accuracy of your polar alignment.
- 2 *Simon's Law of Impending Overcast*
If everything is going according to plan, you have 15 minutes before the sky clouds over.
- 3 *The Inverse Area Law of Reciprocal Probability*
The smaller the field of view of your photograph, the greater is the chance that a well-lit low-flying aircraft will fly through it.
- 4 *The First Law of Suburban Astrophotography*
Your emulsion will sky-fog in half the time it would take to properly record the object you wish to photograph.
- 5 *Digby's Law of Inevitable Failure*
The chance that your photo will be in focus is directly proportional to the number of other factors which will ruin it anyway.
- 6 *The Law of Non-liability*
The probability that your slides will come back mounted and cut down the middle of each frame is directly proportional to the clarity of the directions you give the photofinisher to leave them uncut and unmounted.
- 7 *The Perfect Polar Alignment Delusion*
If your guidestar fails to drift in declination, you are hallucinating.
- 8 *The Social Interaction Principle*
The time it takes to set up your telescope is directly proportional to the number of people present to "help" you.
- 9 *Digby's Second Law of Inevitable Failure*
The chance that you will forget your cable release at home is inversely proportional to the chance that you will forget your film at home, unless of course, you forget both.

July's Star Party was less well attended than June's, but a success none the less. Phoenix was very cloudy, but the site at Black Canyon City was clear except for some clouds low in the south. Those of you who didn't make the trip missed some fine sights that evening!

Douglas Blanchard brought his 13.1 inch Odyssey, his parents and a friend, Ron Kusera. Ron brought a 6 inch Newtonian that his father rescued from being thrown out in the trash! A worthy deed if ever there was one, for its' optics seemed very good and gave us fine views of Venus. Doug's 13.1 afforded us excellent views of M51, the Whirlpool Galaxy and M97, the Owl Nebula, just to name a couple.

Fulton and Nancy Wright made the trip down from Prescott with their C-90. This same C-90 that gave us such good views of Jupiter and Saturn is the scope they took to Indonesia for the eclipse, but that's another story. Hopefully, you'll be hearing all about their trip at one of the meetings!

Raul Espinoza and his wife were there with their 8 inch Schmidt, and rumor has it that they were taking photographs again! When can we expect to see some of those shots, Raul?

Stanly Gorodenski was there with his 12.5 Cass. and showed us, among other objects, Cassini's division better than one observer had seen it since looking at it with the Society's 24 inch Newtonian! (remember?) Stan also pointed out an interesting asterism south of Scorpius that was very striking. Whether this was an open cluster or just a pretty bunch of stars has not been determined yet.

The Society's 8 inch was there, and gave good views of the Lagoon and Dumbbell Nebulae.

SEPTEMBERS' MEETING

Rick Hill of the Warner and Swasey Station at Kitt Peak will speak to us on "Solar Observing For The Amateur", 8 P.M. September 23 in room C-102 of the Science Building at Phoenix College.

OCTOBER MEETING

On October 28 Dr. David Crawford will speak to our society about the characteristics of observatory sites. Dr. Crawford comes to us from Kitt Peak Observatory and did site testing to determine where the National Observatory was to be built.

DECEMBER MEETING

On December 9 Dr. Raymond E. White will give us a talk about "Ancient Astronomy At Machupicchu". Dr. White, of Stewart Observatory in Tucson, has been researching this subject in South America.

ADDITIONS

We have some new members: Fulton Wright Jr. and Nancy Wright
584 Duck Court
Prescott, Arizona
86301

Phone # 445-4967

Welcome to the P.A.S. !!

Deadline for the September newsletter is Friday, September 9th. Want ads, observations, telescope making notes or anything of an astronomical interest are very welcome. Now's the time to see your name in print!

Send your articles to:

Bill Krist
1205 E. Hubbell St.
Phx. Az. 85006

ease include your phone number in case there any questions. Thank you!